

1.1.1 Discrete and Continuous Quantities

منفصل (Discrete) مقادیر وہ ہیں جنہیں ایک ایک کر کے گنا جا سکے، جیسے کلاس میں طلبہ کی تعداد۔

CS XI

Chapter 1: Computer Systems

Lecture 01 of 20

1.1.1 Discrete and Continuous Quantities

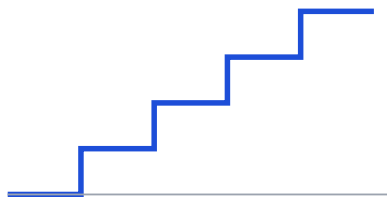
LEARN IT

Everything around you that can be measured or counted is a **quantity**. Quantities come in two kinds.

Discrete quantities are separate, countable items with specific values. You can count them one by one: 1, 2, 3 ... There is nothing "in between". You cannot have 2.5 students in a classroom.

Continuous quantities can take *any* value within a range. They flow smoothly without breaks. Water can be 30 °C, 30.5 °C, 30.51 °C, and so on — there is always another value in between.

Discrete (counted)	Continuous (measured)
Number of students in a classroom	Temperature of water
Number of cars in a parking lot	Speed of a moving car
Has fixed, separate values	Has any value in a range



Discrete (Stairs)



Continuous (Ramp)

Stairs have fixed steps (discrete). A ramp lets you stand at any point (continuous).

REMEMBER IT

Stairs vs Ramp. On stairs you can only stand on step 1, 2 or 3 — that is discrete data. On a ramp you can stand at any height — that is continuous data. Ask yourself: "Do I *count* it or *measure* it?" Count → discrete. Measure → continuous.

COMMON MISTAKE

Students sometimes say "money is continuous because amounts are large". No — rupees and paisa are counted in fixed units, so money is discrete. Size does not matter; what matters is whether values in between are possible.

اردو میں سمجھیں

منفصل (Discrete) مقادیر وہ ہیں جنہیں ایک ایک کر کے گنا جا سکے، جیسے کلاس میں طلبہ کی تعداد۔ مسلسل (Continuous) مقادیر کسی حد کے اندر کوئی بھی قیمت لے سکتی ہیں، جیسے پانی کا درجہ حرارت۔ سیڑھیاں منفصل ڈیٹا کی مثال ہیں اور ڈھلوان (ریمپ) مسلسل ڈیٹا کی۔

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Is the number of pages in a book discrete or continuous?
2. Is your height discrete or continuous?
3. In the stairs/ramp analogy, which one shows continuous data?

Answers: 1. Discrete (you count pages). 2. Continuous (height is measured and can be any value). 3. The ramp.

Next lecture: 1.1.2 Introduction to Digital Systems